

PART VI

Lessons from Notorious Characters

Part VI presents a series of essays by or about notorious Wall Street characters. Why? Because something valuable can be learned from their (mis)deeds. Stock manipulator Daniel Drew, for example, shares what he learned from his shenanigans: "Operators can swear everlasting vengeance on each other one day, and be thick as molasses before sundown the next." T. Boone Pickens, who has been called a corporate raider, a greenmailer, and a piranha, among other names, provides an insightful lesson on what it means to be an active shareholder. In diagnosing what economic circumstances gave rise to Michael Milken and the junk bond craze, James Grant, founder of *Grant's Interest Rate Observer*, explains why debt is a fair-weather friend. Sometimes, those who know how to stretch or even break the rules teach the most memorable lessons.